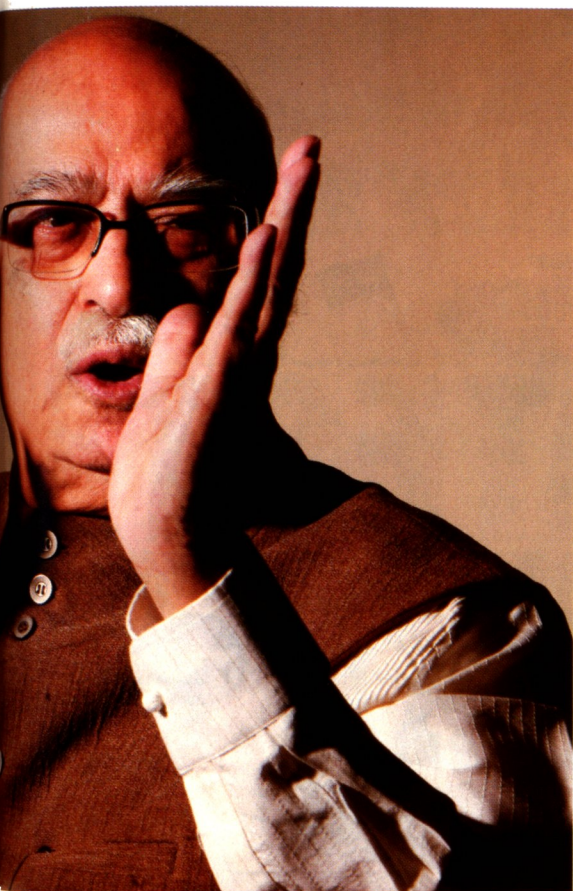


BUILT AGAIN"



Q. You continue to be the most misunderstood politician. Your refinement of thought which comes across in the book, has not been translated into public perception.

A. I can tell you that my party and support base have always understood except recently, and in that, media headlines and TV soundbites played a great role. "Jinnah Secular," says Advani. That's all it takes.

Q. Isn't the current relationship between the prime minister and the leader of Opposition at an all time low?

A. Prime ministers like Chandra Shekhar and Deve Gowda did not have strength of their own. They were sustained by the Congress but even they did not behave like this.

Q. Why is it so vindictive between the two of you?

A. I would not call it vindictive. I still respect him personally. My comments have always focused on his weakness. I have called him the weakest prime minister.

Q. It is not the making of a great friendship.

A. Yes, it hurts him.

Q. What do you make of his appeal to Vajpayee and not you on the nuclear deal?

A. What do I make out of all that has been written by the media about Vajpayee and Advani?

Q. Vajpayee is known as Bhishma Pitamah. What would you call yourself? You are the wordsmith after all.

A. Wordsmith only when coining words like pseudo-secularism, minorityism and cultural nationalism. In India nationalism is not simply because India is one political entity but because of our culture that it is one nation.

Q. What about your own colleagues. Will you trust them again? They have deserted you once.

A. I trust them. They did not understand the context then.

Q. There is no Clinton or Blair in Gen Next to redefine the course of the Indian Right. It is still the old who set the agenda. It was you who set off the biggest debate recently.

A. I was not a senior at that time.

Q. Of course you were. Maybe not the senior most.

A. I have seen Deen Dayalji. When I think of him, I find we are nothing compared to him. The Rath Yatra was not my idea, it was Pramod's. My idea was stereotyped pad

“HARD REALITY IS THAT THE ISSUE OF SONIA GANDHI'S foreign origin remains unresolved. The party's major split came about because of it and privately, even Congressmen talk about it.”



We were confident that we would come back to power. On the basis of our talks, I thought they would agree...after all, everyone realises that Ayodhya cannot be built again.

Q. Everybody realises Ayodhya cannot be built again.

A. No. I said the Masjid cannot be built again. Not that Ayodhya will not be built again. Of that I have no doubt. The Masjid cannot be built again.

Q. You also said that the issue of Sonia Gandhi's foreign origin remains unresolved.

A. That is the hard reality. The Congress party's major split came because of this issue. And privately many of the Congressmen talk about it.

yatra. I said it was too dramatic for me, it did not suit my personality. And see what a difference it made.

Q. Being in active life, how did you write such a big book in such a short time span?

A. Well, I have not been as active as I used to be earlier.

Q. This pause in your public life helped you write.

A. Several people had told me that there was something in my life which ought to be written. I used to say if anyone wants to write a book after my death, let them. But my wife was most insistent that I write.

Q. So is there a last chapter still to be scripted?

A. Laughs.